全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate　第 14 單元

政府、法律與社會 · Government, Law & Society

Small Government, Big Lessons

小小政府，大大啟示

Every October, something that looks very much like a national election takes place at Minsheng Senior High School in Taipei. Posters cover the hallways, candidates give speeches in the cafeteria, and for one week every student becomes a voter. The student council, which has governed school activities since 1998, is more than a club. It has its own constitution, an elected president, and a committee for almost everything, from the school festival to the lunch menu.

The council's authority is real, though limited. It can propose rules, but any new rule needs the approval of the school administration before it can be enforced. Two years ago, for example, the council tried to ban homework during the week of the music festival. The teachers rejected the idea, so the students organized a polite boycott of the cafeteria instead. In the end, both sides reached an agreement: homework stayed, but the festival was extended by one day.

What makes the system work, according to the civics teacher who serves as its adviser, is the idea of equality. Every class sends one delegate, regardless of grades, and every delegate has one vote. When a dispute arises, a five-member committee listens to the evidence like a small jury and gives a judgment that both sides have promised to accept. "Justice in a school is not about punishment," the teacher says. "It is about being heard."

This year's president is Nguyen Mei-lan, the daughter of immigrants from Vietnam. In her declaration of candidacy, she promised to make the council a bridge between the school and the local community, starting with a charity drive for the elderly. Whether or not she succeeds, her classmates have already learned something no textbook can teach: governing people is harder than complaining about them.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句

candidate	*n.*	候選人	Three candidates are running for class leader. 有三位候選人競選班長。
council	*n.*	議會；委員會	The city council will vote on the new park next week. 市議會下週將對新公園進行表決。
constitution	*n.*	憲法；章程	The constitution protects every citizen's right to vote. 憲法保障每位公民的投票權。
authority	*n.*	權力；權威	The principal has the authority to cancel classes. 校長有權取消課程。
approval	*n.*	批准；同意	The plan needs the approval of the whole committee. 這項計畫需要整個委員會的批准。
enforce	*v.*	執行；實施	The police will enforce the new traffic law from Monday. 警方將從週一開始執行新的交通法規。
boycott	*n.*	抵制	The students organized a boycott of the cafeteria's plastic cups. 學生發起抵制餐廳塑膠杯的行動。
delegate	*n.*	代表	Each country sent a delegate to the climate meeting. 每個國家都派出一名代表參加氣候會議。
jury	*n.*	陪審團	The jury found the man not guilty. 陪審團判定這名男子無罪。
immigrant	*n.*	移民（移入者）	Many immigrants from Southeast Asia now live in Taoyuan. 許多來自東南亞的移民現在住在桃園。

片語 Phrases

take place	舉行；發生	The school festival takes place every December. 校慶每年十二月舉行。
in the end	最後	In the end, we decided to take the train. 最後我們決定搭火車。
regardless of	不論；不管	Everyone can join the club, regardless of age. 不論年齡，每個人都可以加入社團。

文法與句型 Grammar

What＋S＋V＋be＋N（名詞子句當主詞）

what 引導的名詞子句可以當句子的主詞，意思是「…的事物」。文章第三段：What makes the system work ... is the idea of equality.

What she said at the meeting surprised everyone.

她在會議上所說的話讓每個人都很驚訝。

Whether or not＋S＋V, S＋V

「無論是否…」，表示不管條件如何，主要子句的結果都成立。文章第四段：Whether or not she succeeds, her classmates have already learned...

Whether or not it rains, the game will go on.

無論下不下雨，比賽都會照常進行。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。